

Parent Guide — middle / module-15-project-implementation

IKS Curriculum

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Parent Guide — Module 15: Project Implementation (Capstone)

Your child's age: Middle (Grades 6–8) · **Module length:** 10 sessions × 45 min over ~2 weeks

What this module is

This is the capstone of the Indian Knowledge Systems curriculum. Across Modules 1–14 your child has met a range of frameworks — the five elements (*pañcabhūta*), Ayurvedic *doṣa*, dot-method arithmetic, moon-phase *tithi*, yoga *āsana*, herb identification, the movement of the sun, ecology, and Vedic mathematics. In Module 15 they pick **one project** that applies one of those frameworks to a real question, and they run it through a structured 10-day cycle: scope → research → design → build → document → share.

This is **not a new content module**. It is a *project sprint*. The new learning is how to run an inquiry from start to finish — set a question, find evidence, iterate, source, present.

The project menu

Your child picks one of these. The teacher has the final say on which projects are offered to the class.

1. **Fermented-foods comparative study** — comparing curd, paneer, and a fermented batter. (This is the school-safe form of the Pañcagavya theme; see safety note below.)
2. **Mandala / *prthvī* geometry design** — a hand-drawn mandala using dot-method techniques.
3. **Tithi + saṁkrānti + festival calendar** — a calendar combining moon-phases, sun-positions, and the family's festival schedule.
4. **Herb identification card-deck** — photograph + drawing + description of 10 herbs from your neighbourhood.
5. **Magic-square pattern art** — a valid magic square turned into a piece of visual art.
6. **Yoga sequence design** — a 10-minute sequence designed for a chosen age group, with explanations.
7. **Sustainability audit of the school** — measure water / waste / energy in one area; propose three doable changes.

8. **Doṣa daily-rhythm self-study** — a 7-day journal of what they noticed about their own routine. (NOT a diagnosis.)
9. **Multiplication-method comparison** — timed comparison of traditional column multiplication vs Vedic methods.
10. **Open-design project** — student-proposed, anchored to a prior module, with teacher approval.

Important safety note — Pañcagavya

You may have heard that Pañcagavya is a traditional Ayurvedic preparation using five cow-derived substances, including cow urine and cow dung. **We do not ask students to handle, prepare, taste, or ingest any form of pañcagavya in school.** Cow-urine ingestion has known safety concerns and is not appropriate for school students; raw cow dung carries hygiene risk.

The school-appropriate version of this theme is the **fermented-foods comparative study** (Project 1), which carries the same intellectual lesson (traditional Indian food technology; microbial transformation; Ayurvedic dietetics) safely.

If your child is curious about pañcagavya itself, they may do a library-only research project on it with written parental consent — no handling, balanced sources, written report only.

The 10-day arc

Days	What's happening
1–2	Choose the project; write a one-page plan
3–4	Research — drawing on sources from prior modules
5	Mid-project critique with a partner
6–7	Build the artefact
8	Write up the process
9	Rehearse the share
10	Project share day — small audience

How to help

Helpful: - Be the audience for an early rehearsal — at home, on Day 9 evening. Listen without correcting. - Help locate materials they ask for, but don't go beyond what they asked for. The project is theirs. - Ask “what's the next thing you're doing?” rather than “is it done?” The first question keeps them moving; the second creates pressure. - For homework: read their daily journal entry (1–5 lines). Don't grade it. Just read.

Not helpful: - Doing the build. The struggle is the learning. - Insisting the project be “impressive.” A small, finished, honest project beats a large, half-finished one. - Pushing them to defend “ancient Indian wisdom.” The rubric explicitly rewards intellectual honesty — including acknowledging the limits of any framework.

On the Day 10 share

Day 10 is a small public share with peers and a few invited parents. **It is not a performance.** Students are expected to say what didn't work, alongside what did. Applaud both.

You may be invited. Please come if you can — it matters to your child. Three to five parents in the audience is plenty.

Time commitment at home

Across the 2 weeks:

- Daily journal — 5 min/day, written at school (no home task)
- Research / materials gathering — ~30 min total at home across Days 2–4
- Build at home — only if they couldn't finish in Day 6 / 7's class time. Cap at 30 min and stop.
- Rehearsal — 10 min on Day 9 evening (in front of you or a sibling)

Total home commitment: ~2 hours across the 2 weeks. If it's much more than that, the project is over-scoped — talk to the teacher.

Citation discipline

Every project must cite at least one source — a verse from a prior module's source cache, a reference from a school science textbook, or a primary observation your child made themselves (with date and location). **No invented citations. No “the ancient text says...” without naming the text.** This is a habit we've built since Module 2 and it carries here.

Assessment

Component	Weight
Project artefact	60%
Documentation + journal	20%
Presentation + Q&A	15%
Self + peer reflection	5%

Total 40 marks.

What success looks like

By end of module, your child can:

- Run a small inquiry from a question to a finished artefact.
- Cite real sources, including a primary observation they made themselves.
- Stand in front of a small audience and say *what didn't work* alongside what did.
- Write a 10-day journal that shows how they got there.

Want to go deeper?

Senior band (Grades 9–12) does the same module but with a 500-word critical reflection and a requirement to use at least one primary-source citation. Preview: [curriculum/senior/module-15-project-implementation/README.md](#).

A note on framing

This curriculum frames *pañcagavya*, *doṣa*, *pañcabhūta*, and other IKS concepts as **historical Indian frameworks for organising observation** — not as modern medical advice, and not as substitutes for chemistry, physics, or biology. The Day 10 reflection asks your child to be honest about what their chosen framework captures well and what it doesn't. That honesty is the point, and it is the mark of a serious student of any tradition.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 15 (Middle) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

At a glance

Day	Session title	Lesson file	Activity / assessment
1	Why a Capstone — Tour the Menu	days/day-01-menu-tour.md	Sticky-note interest poll
2	Scoping — The One-Page Plan	days/day-02-scoping.md	Plan submitted
3	Research Begins	days/day-03-research-1.md	activities/activity-01-source-hunt.md
4	Research + First Design Sketch	days/day-04-research-2.md	Sketch shared with partner
5	Mid-Project Critique	days/day-05-critique.md	activities/activity-02-paired-critique.md ; formative
6	Build Session 1	days/day-06-build-1.md	Daily journal check
7	Build Session 2	days/day-07-build-2.md	Daily journal check
8	Document the Process	days/day-08-document.md	Documentation draft
9	Rehearse the Share	days/day-09-rehearse.md	activities/activity-03-rehearsal.md
10	Project Share Day	days/day-10-share.md	Summative + project rubric

Pacing notes

- **This is not a content module.** There are no new frameworks to deliver. The teacher's role is coaching: keep each student moving from scope → research → design → build → document → share without getting stuck in any one phase.
- **Day 5 is the single most important pacing checkpoint.** By end of Day 5 every student should have a plan, two sources, and a sketch. If they don't, intervene that evening — don't let the gap widen into Days 6–7.
- **Days 6 and 7 are quiet build sessions.** Resist the urge to add new content. Walk the room. Ask “what's the next thing you'll do?” Keep moving.
- If your class needs an extra day, the most expendable session is Day 4 — research can spill into Days 5 and 6. Do not drop Day 5 (critique) or Day 9 (rehearsal); they are where the largest quality gains happen.

Project selection schedule

- **Day 1** — students browse the menu; sticky-note their top two choices on the board.
- **Day 2 morning (before class)** — teacher confirms project assignments. No more than 4 students per project type; cap herb-deck at 6 because it has the most spread.
- **Day 2 in class** — locked-in choices; one-page plan written.

Daily journal — the running thread

Every student keeps a project journal. One entry per day, ~5 lines, written in the last 3 minutes of class (or on the bus home if class runs over). The journal answers:

- *What did I do today?*
- *What's the next thing I'll do?*
- *What's blocking me, if anything?*

Teacher does a quick journal check on Days 4, 6, 7, and 9. Two ticks = on track. One tick = check in tomorrow. No tick = sit with the student for 5 minutes.

Assessment weighting

Component	Weight
Project artefact (rubric)	60%
Documentation + journal	20%
Presentation + Q&A	15%
Self + peer reflection	5%

Total 40 marks. See `assessments/rubric.md` for the detailed scale.

Audience for the share

Day 10's project share is for **peers + at least 3 invited parents or staff**. The mixed audience matters — students learn to speak to people who weren't in the room for the prior lessons. Send the parent invite by Day 5.

What this module is NOT

- It is not a chance to “introduce one more framework.” Resist.
- It is not a free-for-all. Every project must be anchored to a prior module.
- It is not a competition. The rubric rewards process honesty as much as polish.

What students leave the module with

- One finished project, completed without rescue from the teacher in the last 48 hours.
- A 10-entry journal showing how they got there.
- A rehearsed 4-minute share, given to a real audience.
- The intellectual habit of saying “*here’s what I tried, here’s what worked, here’s what didn’t*” — out loud, in public.

Homework

Homework — Module 15 Project Implementation (Middle)

This is a project-sprint module. Homework is light most days and concentrated in the build phase. None of these tasks should exceed 25 minutes for a Middle-band student. **The journal entry is non-negotiable; everything else is task-shaped.**

Day 1 → Day 2

Task: Skim the project menu once more. Open the `sources.md` of the prior module your top choice anchors to. Bring two shortlisted options in writing tomorrow.

Journal entry tonight (3 lines): “*My top choice is ____ because . My second choice is .*”

Time: 10 min.

Day 2 → Day 3

Task: Locate your anchor module’s `sources.md` and read it. Tag one source you’ll definitely use.

Bring tomorrow: all materials you have at home for your project (gather them in one bag tonight).

Time: 10 min.

Day 3 → Day 4

Task: Read the FULL cache chunks of any source you cited today (not just the one verse). Often the surrounding text adds context.

Optional: If a source you want isn't in any cache, search for the chapter in a school library or ask a parent. Bring what you found.

Time: 15 min.

Day 4 → Day 5

Task: Refine your sketch at home if you want. Do NOT start a second sketch — keep iterating on the first.

Photograph your sketch + your three citation slips. Bring photos or originals to Day 5.

Read your partner's sticky-note comment from Day 4. Don't react yet — just hold it for tomorrow's critique.

Time: 10 min.

Day 5 → Day 6

Task: Re-read your critic's notes overnight. Decide which **three changes** you'll make over Days 6–7. Write them in your journal.

Bring ALL materials to class tomorrow. Build session starts the moment you sit down. Anything you forget cannot be retrieved during class.

Time: 10 min.

Day 6 → Day 7

Task: Finish at home **only what you couldn't finish in class today**. Cap at 20 minutes and stop. Done-is-better-than-perfect.

Bring tomorrow: all materials again. Day 7 finishes the build.

Time: up to 20 min, no more.

Day 7 → Day 8

Task: Cap home-work at **20 minutes**. If you have a partner, agree tonight (text or call) on who does what last bit. Don't duplicate.

Read tonight's journal entry aloud to a parent or sibling. This is good rehearsal of what you'll write up tomorrow.

Time: 20 min + 5 min reading aloud.

Day 8 → Day 9

Task: Read your documentation aloud to a family member tonight. Ask: "*Does this make sense to someone who wasn't in the class?*" Note the answer.

Fix anything that didn't make sense. Bring documentation + artefact tomorrow.

Time: 15 min.

Day 9 → Day 10

Task: One final rehearsal at home tonight, in front of a parent or sibling. Time it. Aim for 4 minutes $\pm$ 15 seconds.

Pack everything tonight, not tomorrow morning: artefact + documentation + notes.

Sleep on time. A clear-headed 4-minute share lands better than an over-rehearsed exhausted one.

Time: 15 min rehearsal + 5 min packing.

After Day 10

No homework. Module is complete.

If your next module begins immediately, look at that module's README.md for the prerequisite reading. Otherwise, **rest**. A capstone is genuinely tiring; honour that.

The non-negotiable: daily journal

Every night, regardless of other homework:

One entry in the project journal. Three lines: - What I did today. - What I'll do tomorrow. - What's blocking me, if anything.

This is the running thread of the entire module. It is part of the documentation rubric. Don't skip it.

Cumulative home time across the module

Day	Approx. minutes at home
1	10
2	10
3	15
4	10
5	10
6	up to 20
7	20
8	15
9	20
10	0
Total	~130 min over 10 days

If your home time is consistently more than that, your project is over-scoped. Talk to the teacher.